

Explore the interactive website.

Open each scene to learn more about the colours used. Click the link or scan the QR code to try the interactive website.

<https://film.omartaheri.com>



OMAR TAHERI

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The Wolf of Wall Street.

Ambition, wealth and the illusion of control.
A colour analysis of Martin Scorsese's The Wolf of Wall Street.



The story of Jordan Belfort. From a nobody to the top of Wall Street, as one of its most persuasive salesmen.



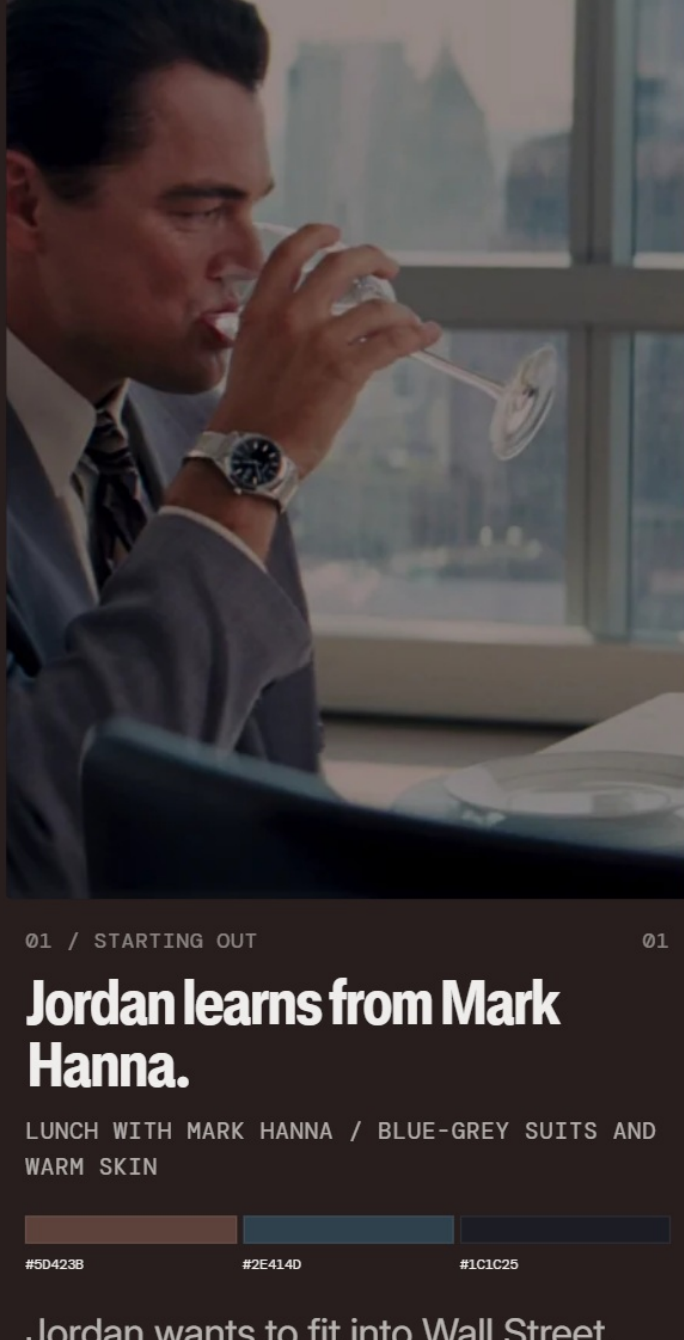
salesmen.

COLOUR
AS
STORY

Blue suits help Jordan look professional. Warm light and bright white clothes make his rich lifestyle look enjoyable. Later, the same expensive things show the problems he has caused. What happens in the story changes how we understand the colours.

See it in colour.

Explore the scenes that tell Jordan's story.

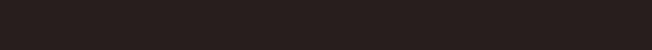


01 / STARTING OUT

01

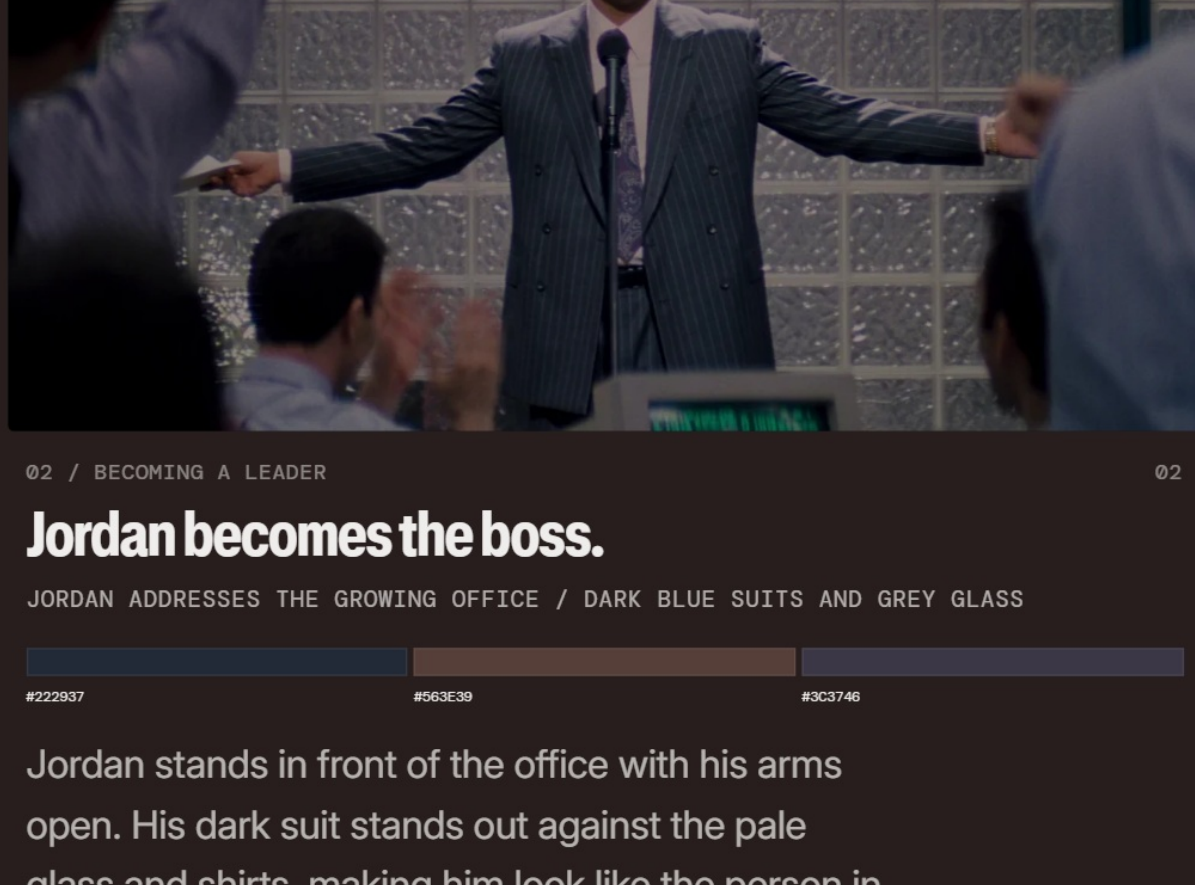
Jordan learns from Mark Hanna.

LUNCH WITH MARK HANNA / BLUE-GREY SUITS AND WARM SKIN



Jordan wants to fit into Wall Street. The blue-grey suits make the men look professional, while the warm colours of their faces make the lunch feel friendly.

MOOD HOPEFUL · INTERESTED

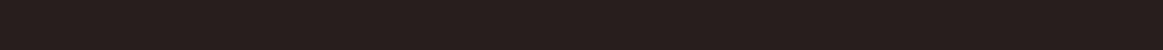


02 / BECOMING A LEADER

02

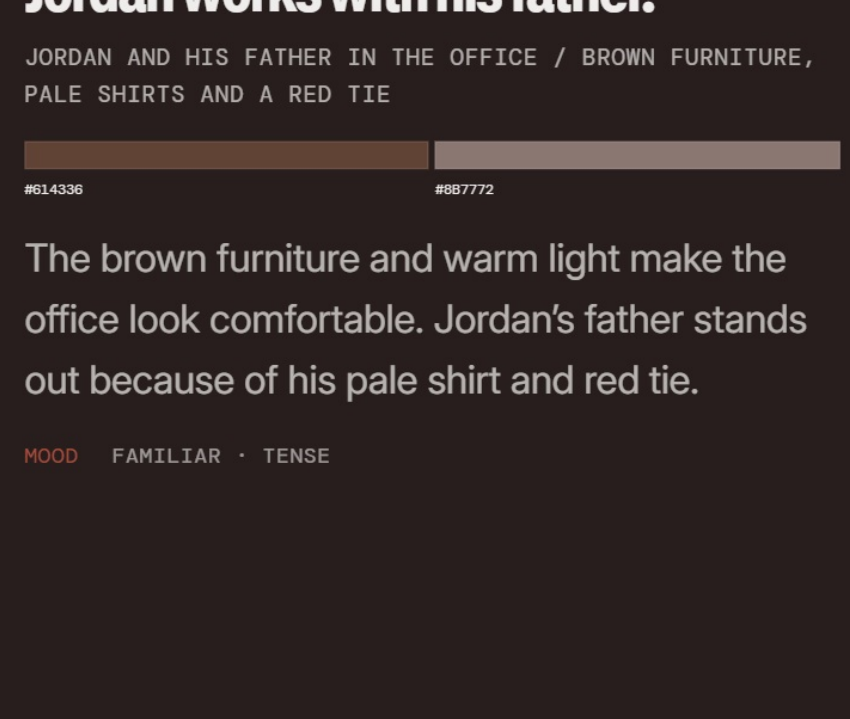
Jordan becomes the boss.

JORDAN ADDRESSES THE GROWING OFFICE / DARK BLUE SUITS AND GREY GLASS



Jordan stands in front of the office with his arms open. His dark suit stands out against the pale glass and shirts, making him look like the person in charge.

MOOD CONFIDENT · AMBITIOUS

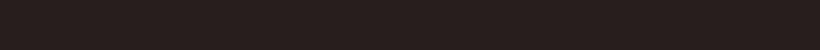


03 / FAMILY AT WORK

03

Jordan works with his father.

JORDAN AND HIS FATHER IN THE OFFICE / BROWN FURNITURE, PALE SHIRTS AND A RED TIE



The brown furniture and warm light make the office look comfortable. Jordan's father stands out because of his pale shirt and red tie.

MOOD FAMILIAR · TENSE

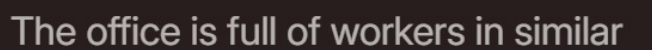


04 / A GROWING TEAM

04

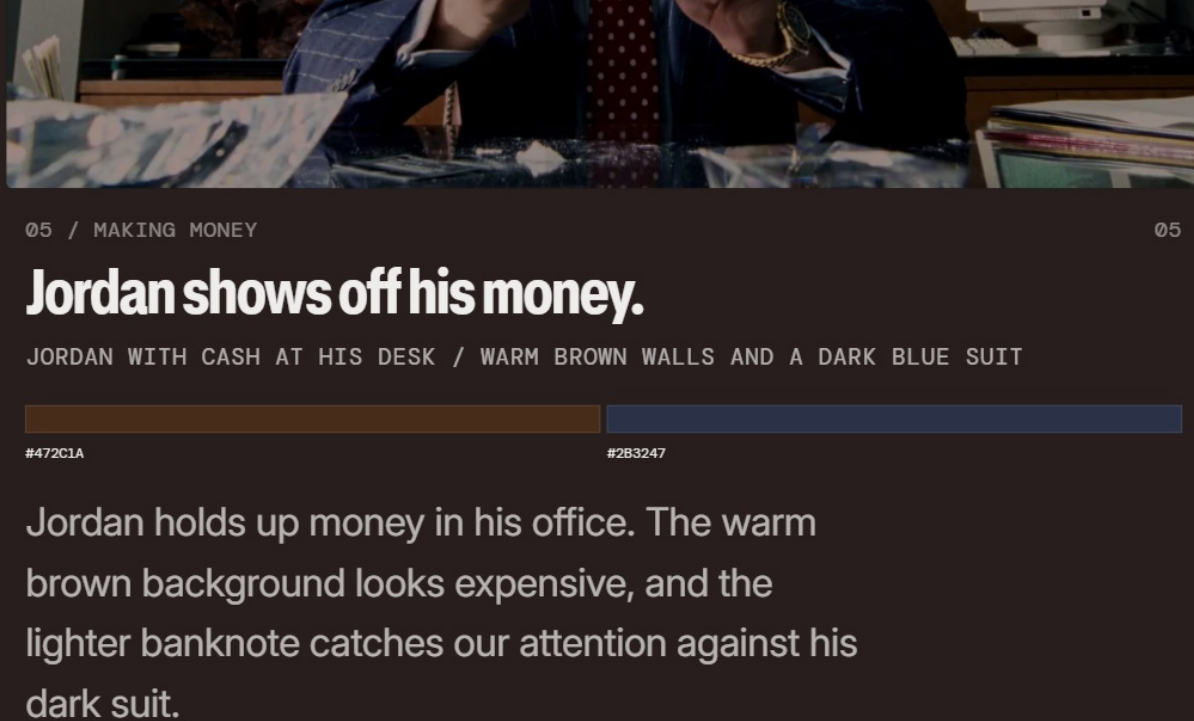
Jordan's team gets bigger.

THE CROWDED TRADING FLOOR / PALE SHIRTS, DARK SUITS AND COOL LIGHT



The office is full of workers in similar shirts and suits. The repeated colours make them look like one big team following Jordan.

MOOD BUSY · EXCITED

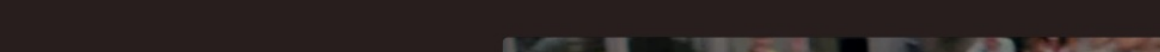


05 / MAKING MONEY

05

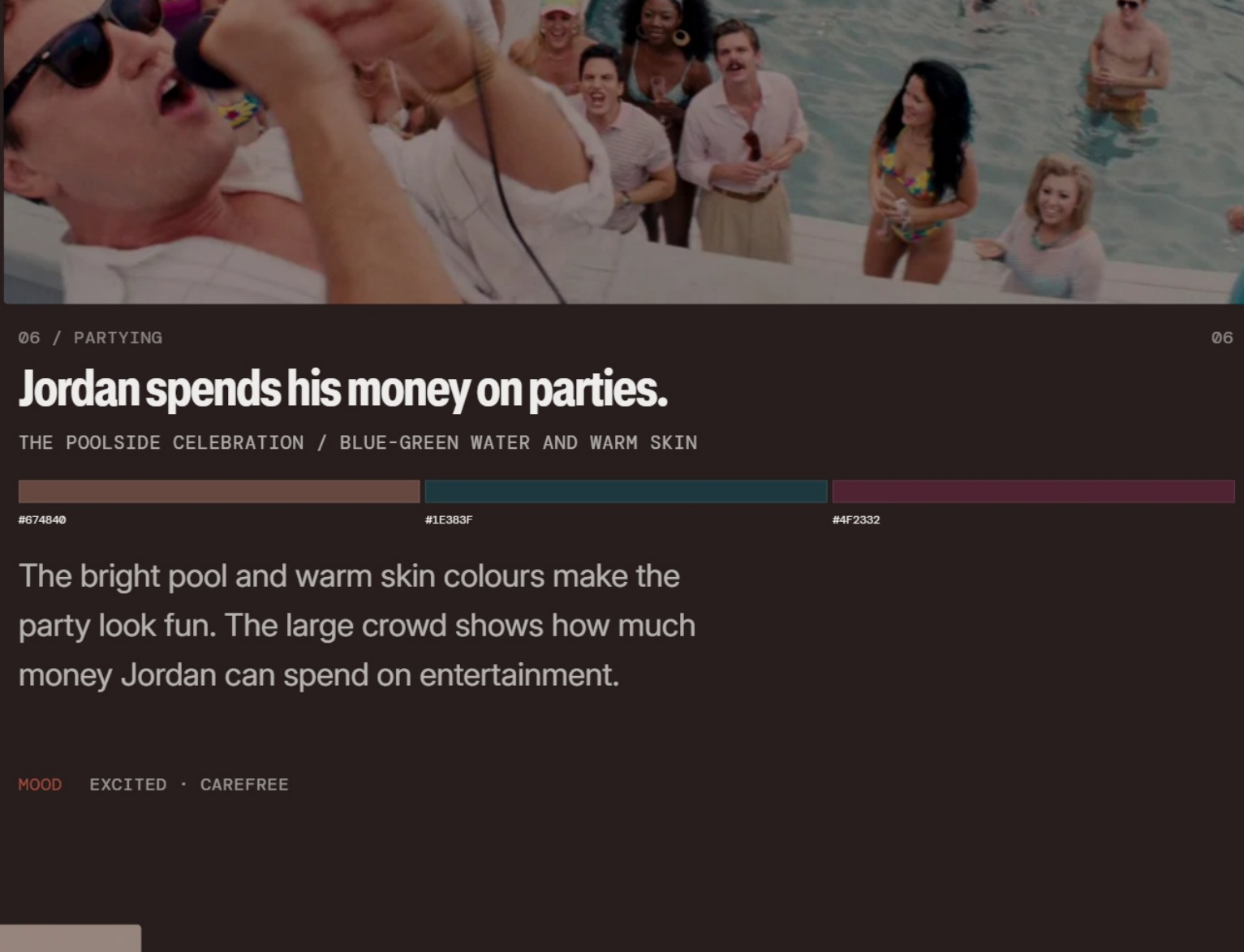
Jordan shows off his money.

JORDAN WITH CASH AT HIS DESK / WARM BROWN WALLS AND A DARK BLUE SUIT



Jordan holds up money in his office. The warm brown background looks expensive, and the lighter banknote catches our attention against his dark suit.

MOOD PROUD · GREEDY

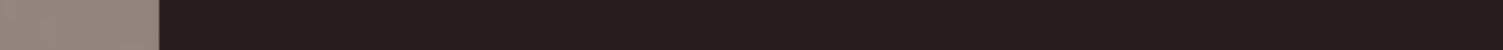


06 / PARTYING

06

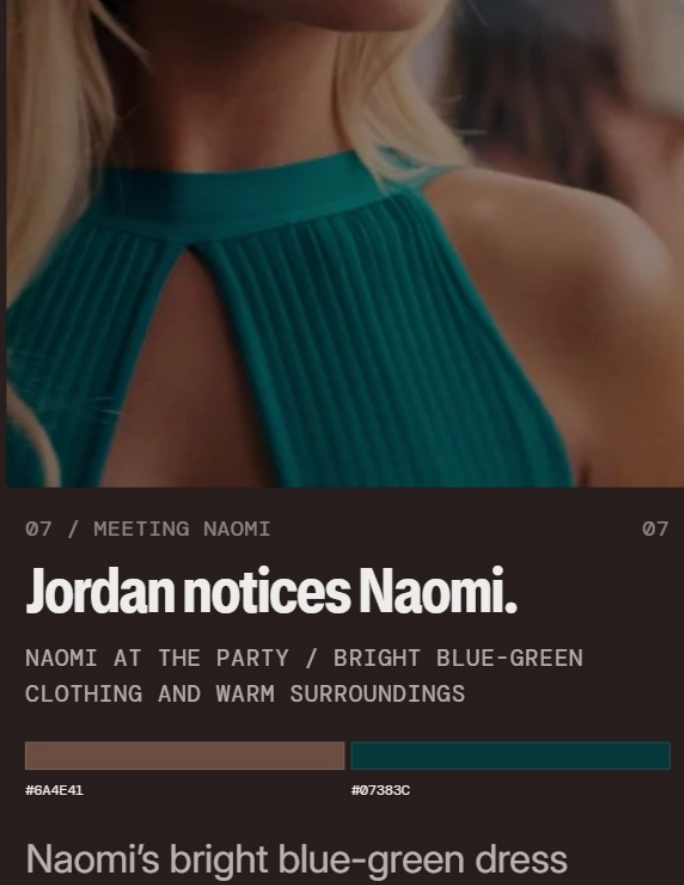
Jordan spends his money on parties.

THE POOLSIDE CELEBRATION / BLUE-GREEN WATER AND WARM SKIN



The bright pool and warm skin colours make the party look fun. The large crowd shows how much money Jordan can spend on entertainment.

MOOD EXCITED · CAREFREE

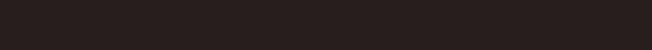


07 / MEETING NAOMI

07

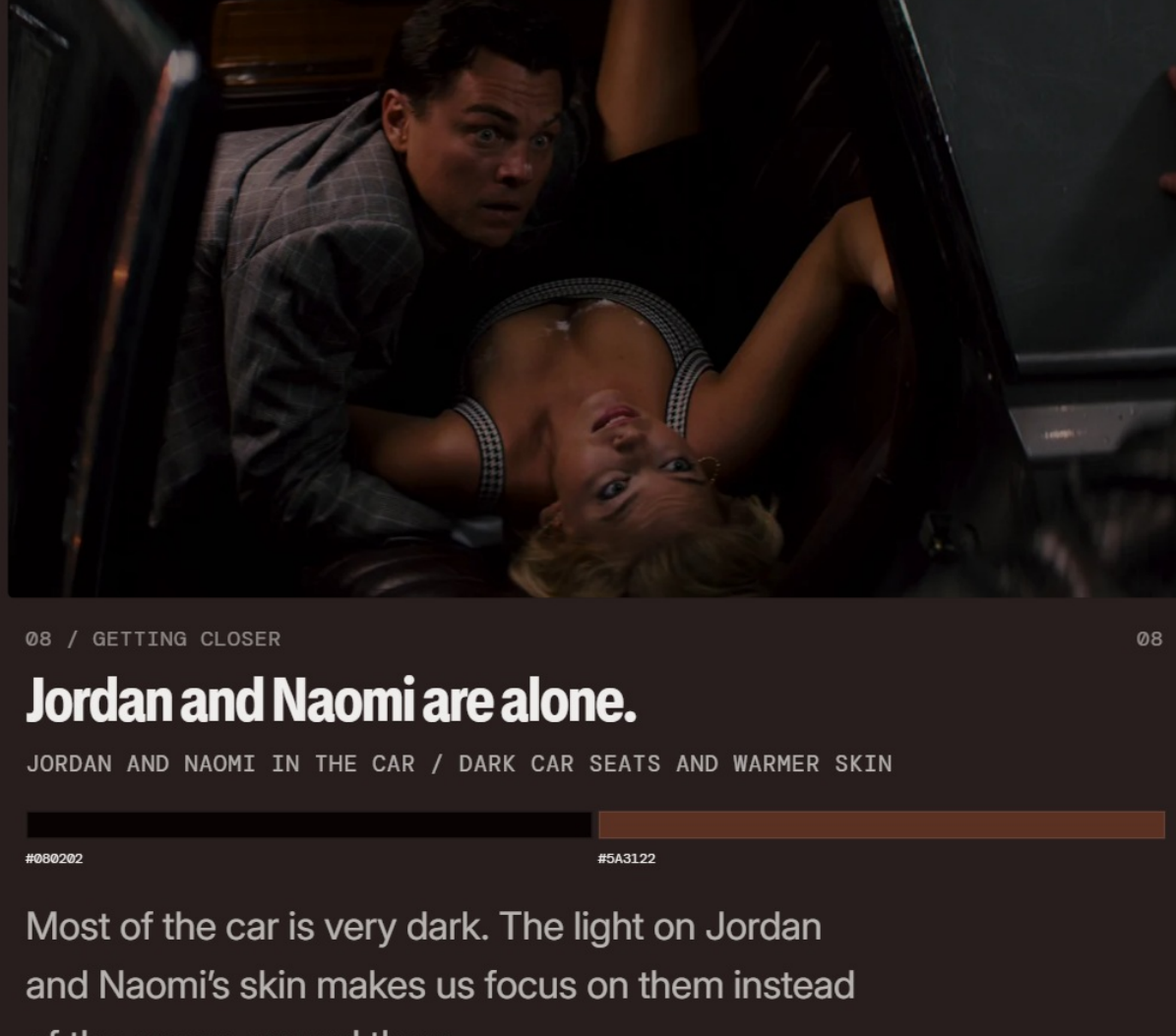
Jordan notices Naomi.

NAOMI AT THE PARTY / BRIGHT BLUE-GREEN CLOTHING AND WARM SURROUNDINGS



Naomi's bright blue-green dress stands out at the party. It draws our attention to her, just as Jordan starts paying attention to her.

MOOD INTERESTED · ATTRACTED

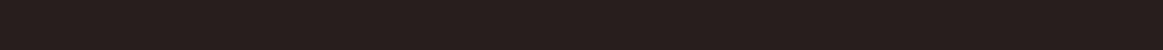


08 / GETTING CLOSER

08

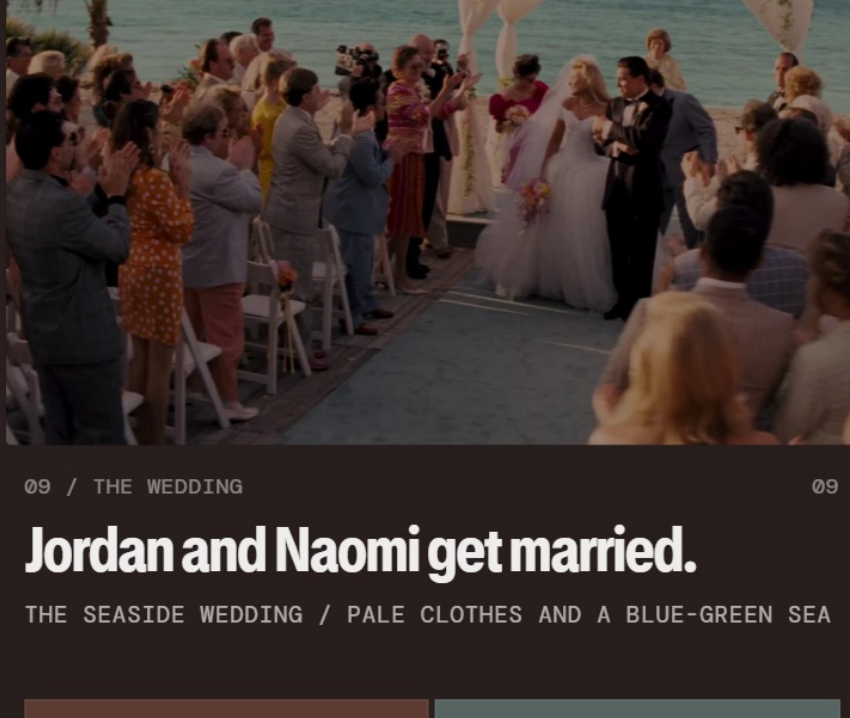
Jordan and Naomi are alone.

JORDAN AND NAOMI IN THE CAR / DARK CAR SEATS AND WARMER SKIN



Most of the car is very dark. The light on Jordan and Naomi's skin makes us focus on them instead of the space around them.

MOOD PRIVATE · TENSE

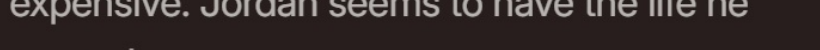


09 / THE WEDDING

09

Jordan and Naomi get married.

THE SEASIDE WEDDING / PALE CLOTHES AND A BLUE-GREEN SEA



The pale clothes, sunny light and blue-green sea make the wedding look happy and expensive. Jordan seems to have the life he wanted.

MOOD HAPPY · RELAXED



10 / SHOWING OFF

10

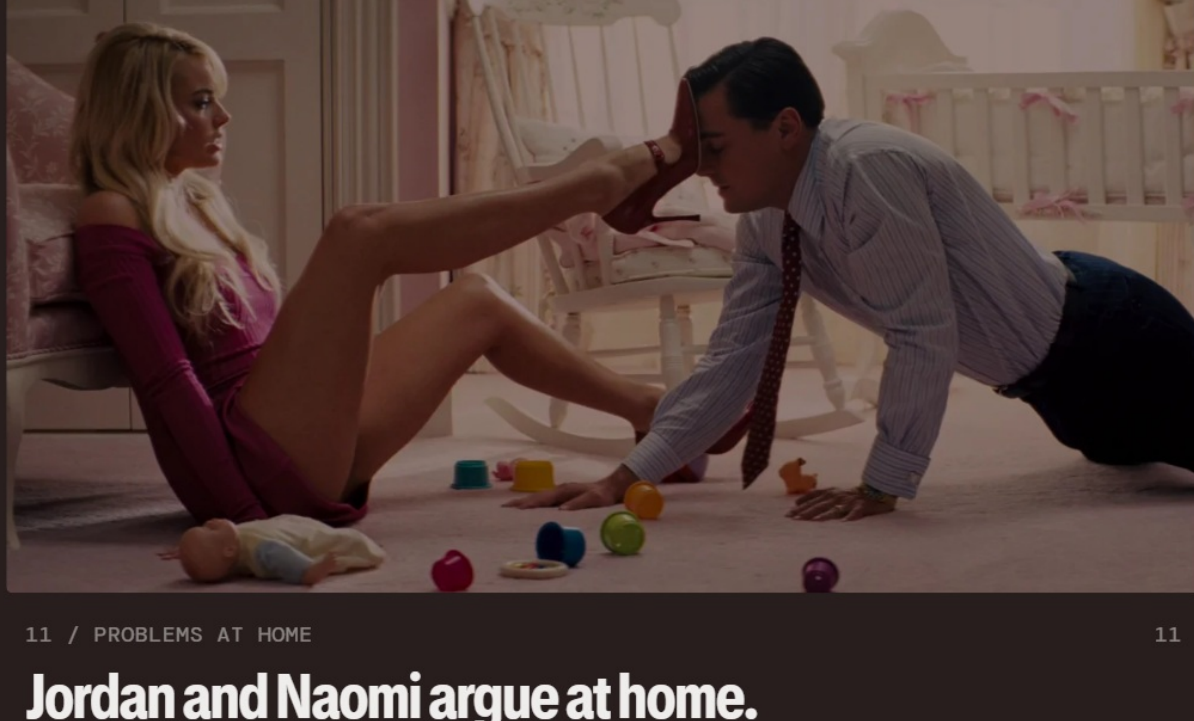
Jordan shows his expensive lifestyle.

JORDAN BESIDE THE CHAUFFEURED CAR / DARK BLUE SUITS AND GREEN GARDENS



Jordan's dark suit looks neat against the green garden. The car and driver show that he can pay other people to look after him.

MOOD PROUD · CONFIDENT



11 / PROBLEMS AT HOME

11

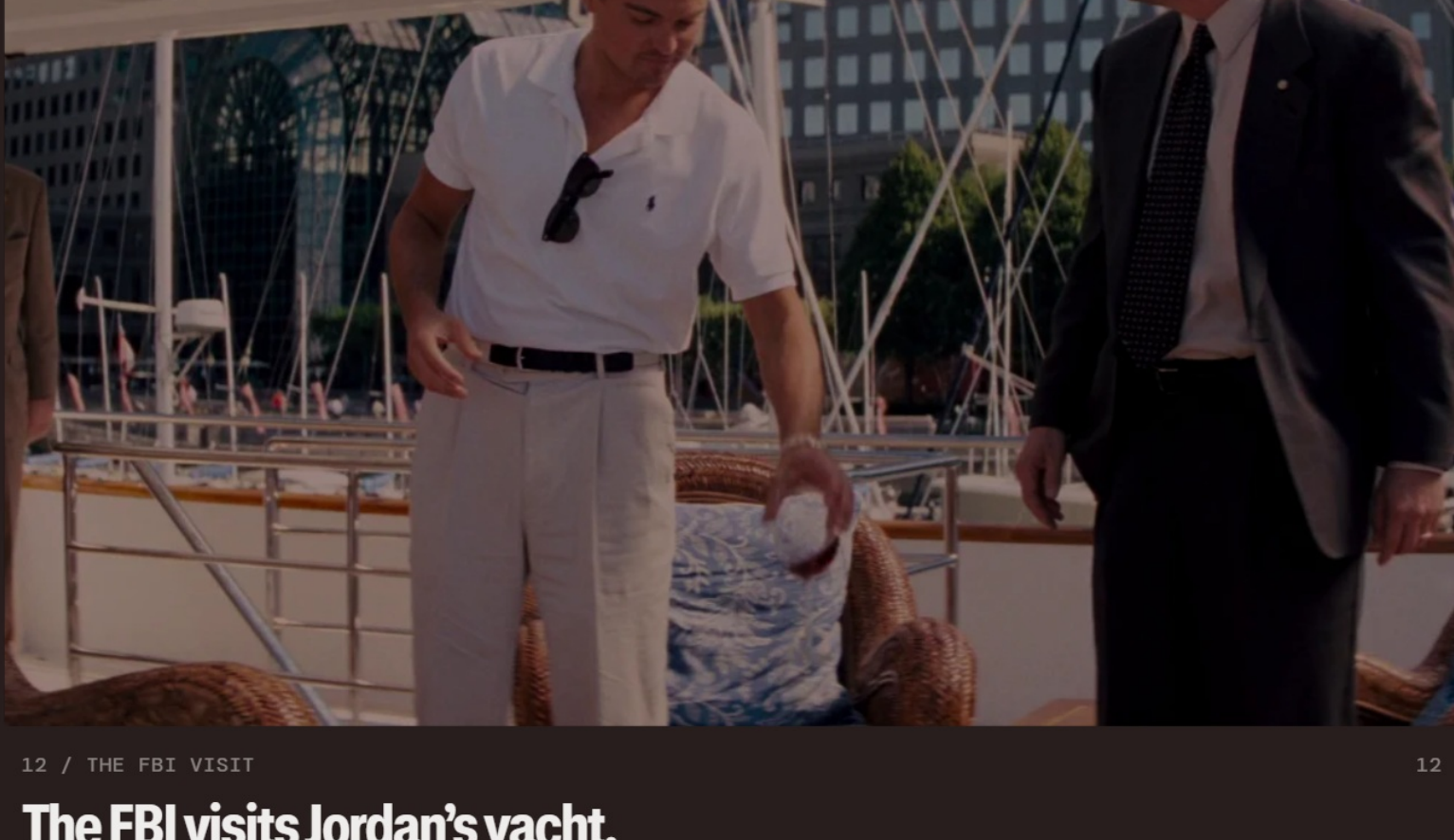
Jordan and Naomi argue at home.

JORDAN AND NAOMI IN THE NURSERY / CREAM FURNITURE, SOFT PINK AND DARK PINK CLOTHING



The nursery's cream furniture and pink colours make it look like a gentle family space. But Jordan and Naomi are arguing, so the room feels very different from what we expect.

MOOD UNHAPPY · TENSE

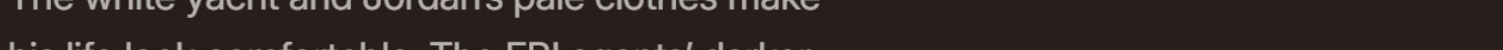


12 / THE FBI VISIT

12

The FBI visits Jordan's yacht.

THE FBI VISIT ON THE YACHT / BRIGHT WHITE SURFACES AND DARK BLUE CLOTHES



The white yacht and Jordan's pale clothes make his life look comfortable. The FBI agents' darker clothes stand out inside this expensive setting.

MOOD CONFIDENT · TENSE

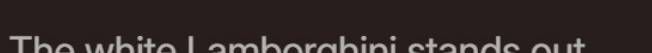


13 / LOSING CONTROL

13

Jordan damages his Lamborghini.

THE DAMAGED WHITE LAMBORGHINI / A WHITE CAR AND A DARK BACKGROUND



The white Lamborghini stands out against the dark surroundings. Its damage shows that Jordan is losing control of himself and his expensive lifestyle.

MOOD CONFUSED · OUT OF CONTROL

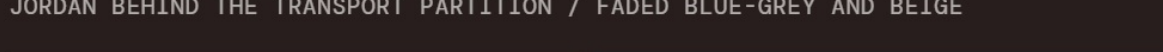


14 / THE CONSEQUENCES

14

Jordan faces the consequences.

JORDAN BEHIND THE TRANSPORT PARTITION / FADED BLUE-GREY AND BEIGE



The plain colours and dark barrier make Jordan's surroundings feel restricted. He no longer looks like the confident man on a yacht or in front of his workers.

MOOD TRAPPED · WORRIED

Colors do develop with the character.

The colours change as Jordan's life changes.
These five stages follow his life from his first job to his final sales seminar.

01 / BEGINNING

Wanting to fit in

When Jordan Belfort has lunch with Mark Hanna, the blue-grey suits and city background make Wall Street look serious and professional. These colours suggest success because they belong to the business world Jordan wants to join. The warmer faces make Hanna's advice feel friendly, even when he is teaching Jordan to take advantage of clients.

02 / RISE

Looking like a leader

As Jordan builds Stratton Oakmont with Donnie Azoff, dark suits and pale shirts appear across the office. Their similar colours make the workers look like one organised team. This helps Jordan look like a trustworthy boss, even though he and Donnie are making money by misleading people.

03 / PEAK

Showing off success

Naomi's bright cyan dress stands out against the warmer colours at the party, drawing our attention to her just as Jordan notices her. Later, pale wedding clothes and the blue-green sea make his rich lifestyle look like a perfect holiday. These colours make his success feel attractive because we connect them with sunshine, comfort and expensive trips.

04 / FALL

Losing control

The soft pink and cream nursery looks like a caring family space, but Jordan and Naomi argue inside it. The colours make their unhappy relationship stand out against the comfortable home. Jordan's white Lamborghini also changes meaning: it first shows his wealth, but after he damages it, the same bright white draws attention to the damage and his loss of control.

05 / ENDING

People still listen

At the final sales seminar, Jordan faces an audience in ordinary clothes and a plain room. The muted colours make this setting feel closer to everyday life than his earlier parties and yacht. Our attention shifts to the people watching him. Even after his crimes, they still want to learn his way of becoming successful.

THE PERFORMANCE CONTINUES

Still selling. Still watching.



The real Jordan Belfort demonstrates his sales approach. A companion video to the film study.
[Watch on YouTube ↗](#)

The End of the Story.

Colour draws us into Jordan Belfort's story and makes the film more fun to watch. The bright parties, blue sea and warm rooms make his rich lifestyle look exciting. We can understand why Jordan wants this life, even when we know how he makes his money.

But in this film, what is happening in the story matters more than the colour by itself. The soft pink nursery looks comfortable, but Jordan and Naomi are arguing. His white Lamborghini looks expensive, but the damage shows that he has lost control. Colour helps us feel the scene, while the characters and their actions help us understand what it means.

TAKE THE STUDY WITH YOU

Keep looking.



SCAN TO EXPLORE
Open the interactive study